

Summary on 'Ceramah Perdana'

According to Prof. Datuk Ir. Dr. Wahid Bin Omar points out that having integrity is important in the academic field. As an academic himself, he is strongly against any form of plagiarism used to advance an academic career. For example, he advised us to refrain from relying fully on any AI generative tools such as ChatGPT as it deprives people of experiencing a sense of achievement from completing a task all on their own. He also mentioned that when someone compromises their integrity, they might continue to do so in the future. To quote he said, "A person's integrity is like a sheet paper, once crumpled the crease remains.". Characteristics or habits of highly excellent individuals were also in his sharing session. The ones that are worth mentioning are those who continuously improve themselves and have the initiative to take in new knowledge.

Mrs. Salmiha Binti Saidin serving under the Malaysian Anti-Corruption Commission (MACC or SPRM) shared her insights on integrity as well. Hers however emphasizes having integrity to combat corruption. She shared a survey on Malaysian's perception of corruption and a staggering 30.5% of student respondents are willing to accept bribes if they are given the power and opportunity to do so. The worst became a reality when more than half or specifically 50.7% of 2,525 SPRM arrests involved teenagers in the span of 5 years (2013-2018). Bribery in her exact words is defined as accepting a bribe intended to make a person do or not do an act related to their official duties. Bribes come in all types and forms such as money, gifts, bonuses even services. She also shared Malaysia's regulations if found guilty which is imprisonment not exceeding 20 years and a fine 5 times more than the bribe or RM 10,000, whichever is more.

As an audience in an academic life track, Prof. Datuk Ir. Dr. Wahid Bin Omar's bits of advice serves its purpose in educating graduates to be honest in all the task given and not misuse technology to further a selfish cause. Mrs. Salmiha Binti Saidin's lecture on the other hand serves its relevance on the importance of having integrity to combat corruption so as to not undermine defense and security institutions, and erode state legitimacy.